

KEEP THE PROOF — VERSION 2

Stage 2 resolution and final change log

Prepared for Temidayo Afonja, The Density Group. September 19, 2026.

This resolves the eleven decision items from your Stage 2 approval. It records what was approved as-is and what was edited, moves the reconstruction separability reasoning into internal notes, restates the exact remaining legal-review list, and confirms manuscript-to-Professional-Record consistency after the changes. Review only. No final designed PDF was generated. No LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED placeholder was removed. Next gate: legal review and final manuscript approval, then design and customer-bundle work.

I. Resolution log

Item 1. Permission sequencing. APPROVED as-is. The basic rule stays early (the one rule in the front matter, the boundary in Part One); the full Permission and Protection treatment stays in Part Three, after recognition and the first understanding of the system. Final wording still governed by legal review. No change made.

Item 2. Cadence. APPROVED as-is. Event-based capture and optional periodic sweeps are presented as valid alternatives that can also work together, with neither asserted as universally better. No change made.

Item 3. Routine labels. SIMPLIFIED. The routines are now "monthly sweep" and "quarterly review" in plain language. The branded "Quarterly Evidence Index" is removed; the Professional Record's index is now an unbranded "running index" (Section 5, "Your index"), and the quarterly routine says "update your index." No framework label proliferates.

Item 4. Quick Capture terminology. RENAMED. The reader-facing field "Verifier role or permitted public reference" is replaced everywhere with "Who could confirm this, or what public source supports it?" The supporting instruction now reads: for a person, note their role and what they directly observed; do not store private contact information; any use of a public source stays subject to the final counsel-confirmed permission language. Updated in the manuscript prompt, the Devin example label, and the Professional Record, so the manuscript and the working artifact are identical.

Item 5. Worked examples. APPROVED as-is. The set covers operations, people and HR, security, engineering management, audit and risk, coordination without authority, judgment under uncertainty, people development, relationship repair, re-entry, and scope without title. No examples were added.

Item 6. Author bio. EDITED. The broader warrant is kept (nearly two decades; eight industries; accounting and audit; cybersecurity; people and workforce; diversity and inclusion; consulting and operating roles). The "through line is not one specialty" sentence is replaced with the approved line, rendered in the bio's third person for internal consistency: "Across those different contexts, she kept getting close to the same questions: how work gets evaluated, what people are trusted to carry, and how careers actually get built." The bio is not a resume.

Item 7. Legal review. MANDATORY, unchanged. L1 through L6 and every LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED marker remain production gates. No placeholder was resolved, removed, or converted into reader-facing guidance. Ten gated markers remain in the manuscript.

Item 8. Page count. APPROVED as a design ceiling and range, 44 to 56 pages, not a target. No design toward a count; space follows the reading experience. No change to the manuscript.

Item 9. Reconstruction separability note. REMOVED from the reader-facing manuscript. The internal reasoning is preserved in Section 2 below, in this internal document. Reader-facing Part Seven now simply explains the equal reconstruction pathway.

Item 10. Closing "prove it" language. REVISED. The About close no longer says capable people "could no longer prove it." It now reads: "Keep the Proof grew out of a pattern that kept recurring: capable people reaching an important career moment and struggling to reconstruct work they had already done." This is consistent with the Claim, Example, Evidence, Corroboration distinction and the recognition-first opening.

Item 11. Consistency QA. Rerun after the changes. Results in Section 4. The renamed Quick Capture field was verified everywhere it appears; manuscript and Professional Record match.

2. Internal note, not reader-facing: reconstruction separability

Moved here from the manuscript per Item 9. This is internal product-development reasoning and must not appear in the customer-facing guide.

The reconstruction material in Part Seven is written and structured so it could stand on its own if it ever needed to. If future evidence from real buyers shows that reconstruction is the moment people most want to buy for, the material is clean enough to lift into a dedicated path without redesign. For Version 2 it lives inside Keep the Proof, because the person who lost access needs the same record everyone else is building, reached through a different door.

3. Exact remaining legal-review list

Unchanged by this pass; none removed, none finalized. Production gate.

- L1. Not-legal-advice statement and confidentiality note (front matter).

- L2. Lawful ways to rebuild the record (Part Three): personnel-record rights, documents the employee may treat as their own, written permission, use of public work.
- L3. Anonymized process accounts (cross-cutting). Standard kept strict pending counsel.
- L4. Corroboration and privacy (Part Four; Professional Record Section 3). Role and observation only. Note: the Quick Capture rename adds a public-source option whose use is explicitly made subject to counsel-confirmed permission language, so it sits under L2 and L4.
- L5. Reconstruction sources near employer-owned information (Part Seven).
- L6. Account-versus-artifact ownership caveat (Part One).

Also carried for counsel, not reader-facing: work-for-hire and portfolio use; contractor versus employee ownership; client confidentiality layered on employer confidentiality; severance and non-disparagement clauses; preservation exceptions; employer AI-tool and monitoring policies.

4. Consistency confirmation

Manuscript-to-Professional-Record, after this pass.

- Renamed Quick Capture field "Who could confirm this, or what public source supports it?": appears identically in the manuscript prompt and in Professional Record Section 1. VERIFIED. The Devin example now uses the matching label. No instance of the old "Verifier role or permitted public reference" or "Permitted verification" remains in either file.
- Index: the manuscript does not brand an index; the Professional Record uses an unbranded "running index" (Section 5). No "Evidence Index" or "Quarterly Evidence Index" label remains in either file.
- Routine labels: monthly sweep and quarterly review, plain, in both.
- All other fields (Full Entry clusters, permission check, team versus individual, judgment, prevention, corroboration, Proof Line, reconstruction certainty labels, retrieval tags): MATCH, unchanged by this pass.
- No reader-facing field asks the reader to store anything the handbook tells them not to store: CONFIRMED. The renamed field explicitly excludes private contact information.

Confirmation, reconstruction separability language is internal only: CONFIRMED. It appears only in Section 2 of this internal document and no longer in the manuscript.

Confirmation, no new product terminology or frameworks introduced: CONFIRMED. This pass introduced no new terms and no new framework. It removed a branded label ("Quarterly Evidence Index") and replaced one field name with plain language. "Your index," "monthly sweep," and "quarterly review" are plain descriptors, not frameworks.

Confirmation, all reader-facing fields match the Professional Record: CONFIRMED, per the field-by-field check above.

5. What happens next

The next gate is legal review of L1 through L6 and your final approval of the manuscript. After that: design and customer-bundle work. Until you give that approval, nothing proceeds to final design, and nothing touches Gumroad, the live Keep the Proof website page, or the current customer bundle.

END OF STAGE 2 RESOLUTION